

English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices, Grade 11

University Preparation (NBE3U)

College Preparation (NBE3C)

Workplace Preparation (NBE3E)

OVERVIEW

“English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” is designed as an alternative to the Grade 11 compulsory courses of the English curriculum. The English curriculum is based on the belief that language learning is essential to responsible and productive citizenship, and that all students can become successful language learners. The curriculum is designed to provide students with the knowledge and skills that they need to achieve this goal. The program helps students develop a range of essential skills in the four interrelated areas of oral communication, reading and literature studies, writing, and media studies, built on a solid foundation of knowledge of the conventions of standard English and incorporating the use of analytical, critical, and metacognitive thinking skills. Students learn best when they are encouraged to consciously monitor their thinking as they learn, and these courses include expectations that call for such reflection.

“English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” focuses on these core competencies through exploration of text forms emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in Canada, and also of the perspectives and influence of texts that relate to those cultures. The knowledge and skills described in the expectations will enable students to understand, respond to, and appreciate a full range of literary, informational, graphic, oral, media, and cultural texts and to create their own texts in a variety of forms.

Cultural text forms such as clothing and regalia, stories, songs, music, dances, and cultural practices embody social and cultural meanings in relation to their use in contemporary and historical contexts. Exploration of these text forms is therefore a crucial component of “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices”. It is critically important that students are taught to engage responsibly with these text forms, as well to follow appropriate cultural protocols to ensure respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. These protocols vary from nation to nation.

STRANDS

The Grade 11 compulsory courses of the English curriculum are organized in four strands, or broad areas of learning: Oral Communication, Reading and Literature Studies, Writing, and Media Studies. In “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” these four strands are preceded by strand A: First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Perspectives and Text Forms in Canada. Although strand A is presented separately from the areas of learning presented in strands B–E, in practice students constantly apply the knowledge and approaches included in strand A as they work to achieve the expectations in all areas of learning.

The knowledge and skills described in strands B–E are interdependent and complementary. Teachers plan activities that blend expectations from the strands in order to provide students with the kinds of experiences that promote meaningful learning and that help them recognize how literacy skills in the four areas reinforce and strengthen one another.

A. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Perspectives and Text Forms in Canada

Identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance are key concepts in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. As students explore texts emerging from and/or related to diverse Indigenous cultures, they learn to identify and analyse these concepts, formulating questions and comparing perspectives to stimulate a well-reasoned exchange of ideas. Through reading, listening, discussing, and writing about text forms in Canada, students also deepen their understanding of how textual representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and cultures are influenced by perspectives related to or shaped by historical period, cultural background, and social and political conditions and events, including perspectives related to gender and the role of women.

It is critically important that students learn to appreciate the responsibility that the creators of text forms in Canada have to affirm and acknowledge First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, world views, and diversity through authentic and complete representations of Indigenous lives.

B. Oral Communication

Oral language is a fundamental means of communication with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Through talk, students not only communicate information but also explore and come to understand ideas and concepts; identify and solve problems; organize their experience and knowledge; and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. When they converse about information and ideas, they become aware not only of the various perspectives of other speakers and writers but also of the language structures and conventions they use. As students work towards achieving the expectations for this strand, they will improve their ability to explore and communicate ideas in both classroom and formal speaking situations.

To develop their oral communication skills, students need numerous opportunities to listen and to talk about a range of subjects, including personal interests, cultural knowledge, school work, and current affairs. Students should be provided with opportunities to engage in various thought-provoking oral activities in connection with expectations in all the strands – for example, brainstorming to identify what they know about the topic of a new text they are about to read, discussing strategies for solving a problem in a writing

assignment, presenting and defending ideas or debating issues, and offering informal critiques of work produced by their peers.

As students explore various text forms associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, they learn how to select and use culturally appropriate listening practices to further their understanding of the lessons and knowledge to be gained from traditional stories, including historical knowledge. They also gain insight into the social, economic, and political forces that affect the transmission of stories, as well as the significance of these stories not only to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities but also to Canadian society as a whole.

It is important for students to develop an understanding that some knowledge is sacred and may be shared only with permission and/or in certain situations. As a result, recording or reproducing an oral teaching, a story, or a song may require explicit permission from the knowledge holder and/or community.

Listening and speaking are essential skills for social interaction at home, at school, and in the community. In order for all students to benefit from the opportunities provided in the classroom for listening and speaking, differences in the norms and conventions associated with oral communication in different cultures must be taken into account. In addition, for some students, the notion that learning involves talk is unfamiliar, and talk that supports learning must be explicitly taught and modelled. All students can benefit from opportunities to improve their listening and response skills and to refine their ideas and their ability to express them.

The Oral Communication strand focuses on the identification and development of the skills and strategies effective listeners and speakers use to understand and interact with others. It also emphasizes the use of higher-order thinking skills to stimulate students' interest and engage them in their own learning.

C. Reading and Literature Studies

"English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices" focuses on developing the knowledge and skills that will enable students to become effective readers. An effective reader is one who not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the reader must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts in order to understand, analyse, and absorb them and to recognize their relevance in other contexts. Students can develop the skills necessary to become effective readers by applying a range of comprehension strategies as they read and by reading a wide variety of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources. It is also important that they read a range of materials that illustrate the many uses of writing. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary and become more attuned to the conventions of written language. Reading various kinds of texts in all areas of the curriculum will also help students to discover what interests them most and to pursue and develop their interests and abilities.

Reading is a complex process that involves the application of various strategies before, during, and after reading. For example, before reading, students might prepare by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text. Teachers help build the necessary background knowledge for students

whose life experiences may not have provided them with the information they need to understand the text. During reading, students may use “cueing systems” – that is, clues from context or from their understanding of language structures and/or letter-sound relationships – to help them solve unfamiliar words, and comprehension strategies to help them make meaning of the text. Comprehension strategies include predicting, visualizing, questioning, drawing inferences, identifying main ideas, summarizing, and monitoring and revising comprehension. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. It is essential that teachers provide adequate time for students to apply various strategies before, during, and after reading not only in order to develop reading skills but also to ensure that there is an opportunity to support students who may find some texts emotionally difficult due to their own experiences and connections to the material.

Teachers must use their professional judgement in deciding which comprehension strategies to model and teach, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms and on the nature of the particular texts students are reading.

Fluent, independent readers read frequently for a variety of different purposes – to locate information, to satisfy curiosity, for enjoyment, to build vocabulary, for research, and for various more specifically defined purposes. The purpose for reading will be determined by the teacher in some cases and by the student in others. The reading program should include a wide variety of literary, informational, and graphic texts that engage students’ interest and imagination – for example, novels; poetry; short stories; textbooks and books on topics in science, history, mathematics, geography, and other subjects; biographies, autobiographies, memoirs, and journals; plays and radio, film, or television scripts; encyclopaedia entries; graphs, charts, and diagrams in textbooks or magazines; instructions and manuals; graphic novels, comic books, and cartoons; newspaper and magazine articles and editorials; databases and websites; and essays and reports. Teachers should routinely provide materials that reflect the diversity of Indigenous peoples. Frequent exposure to good writing will inspire students to work towards high standards in their own writing and will help them develop an appreciation for the power and beauty of the written word.

This strand helps students learn to read with understanding, to read critically, to become familiar with various text forms and their characteristic elements, and to recognize the function and effects of various text features and stylistic devices. It helps students understand that reading is a process of constructing meaning and equips them with the strategies that good readers use to understand and appreciate what they read.

D. Writing

A central goal of the Writing strand is to promote students’ growth as confident writers and researchers who can communicate competently using a range of forms and styles to suit specific purposes and audiences and correctly applying the conventions of language – grammar, usage, spelling, and punctuation. These conventions are best learned in the context of meaningful and creative writing activities that allow students to develop the ability to think and write clearly and effectively on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

Writing, from initial musings to final publication, is a complex process that involves a range of complementary thinking and composing skills, as well as other language processes,

including reading, speaking, and listening. As writers compose, they consider their audience; make decisions about form, style, and organization; and apply their knowledge of language use. To develop these competencies, students need a supportive classroom environment, with opportunities to extend and refine their skills in using the writing process and doing research. Students need opportunities to apply these skills and to write daily, in many forms and genres, for a variety of purposes and audiences, and within different time constraints. The forms and genres explored may include essays, reports, short stories, poetry, scripts, journals, letters, biographies, children's stories, articles, blog posts, reviews, précis, explanations, instructions, notes, procedures, and advertisements. Because post-secondary institutions and employers require clear, well-organized writing, on demand and within strict timelines, students also need to learn and practise strategies for writing effectively and correctly in the context of in-class writing assignments and test situations.

Students benefit from opportunities to produce writing that is interesting and original and that reflects their capacity for independent critical thought on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. Writing activities that students find meaningful and that challenge them to think creatively about topics and concerns that interest them will lead to a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing.

Writing on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures needs to be approached sensitively. Students learn to take into account the responsibility to ensure that their work is free from bias, stereotypes, misinformation, and cultural appropriation.

The overall expectations in this strand focus on the elements of effective writing (ideas/content, organization, voice, word choice, sentence fluency, language conventions, and presentation) and on the stages of the recursive writing process (planning for writing, drafting, revising, editing and proofreading, and publishing). In the specific expectations, the examples and sample questions refer to writing forms and language conventions that are appropriate for instruction in the given course. The forms and conventions noted are not, however, the only ones that may be taught in the course. Teachers will continue to use their professional judgement to decide on the forms and conventions students will study, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms.

E. Media Studies

The Media Studies strand focuses on the art, meaning, and messaging of various forms of media texts emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources. Media texts can be understood to include any work, object, or event that communicates meaning to an audience. Most media texts use words, graphics, sounds, and/or images, in print, oral, visual, or electronic form, to communicate information and ideas to their audience. Whereas traditional English language study may be seen to focus primarily on the understanding of the word, media studies focuses on the construction of meaning through the combination of several media "languages" – images, sounds, graphics, and words.

Media studies explores the impact and influence of mass media and popular culture by examining texts such as films, songs, video games, action figures, advertisements, music advertising media, clothing, billboards, television and streaming content, magazines, newspapers, photographs, and websites. These texts abound in our electronic information age, and the messages they convey, both overt and implied, can have a significant influence on students' lives. For this reason, critical thinking as it applies to media products

and messages assumes a special significance. Understanding how media texts are constructed and why they are produced enables students to respond to them intelligently and responsibly. Students must be able to differentiate between fact and opinion; evaluate the credibility of sources; recognize bias; be attuned to discriminatory portrayals of individuals and groups, such as Indigenous peoples, religious or sexual minorities, people with disabilities, or seniors; and question depictions of violence and crime.

Students' repertoire of communication skills should include the ability to critically interpret the messages they receive through the various media and to use these media to communicate their own ideas effectively as well. Skills related to media such as the Internet, film, and television are particularly important because of the power and pervasive influence these media wield in our lives and in society. Becoming conversant with these and other media can greatly expand the range of information sources available to students, and enhance potential career opportunities in the communication and entertainment industries.

To develop their media literacy skills, students should have opportunities to view, analyse, and discuss a wide variety of media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit sources, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources and relate them to their own experience and/or understanding. They should also have opportunities to use available technologies to create media texts of different types (e.g., computer graphics, cartoons, graphic designs and layouts, podcasts, short videos, blogs, web pages).

This strand focuses on helping students develop the skills required to understand, create, and critically interpret media texts. It examines how images (both moving and still), sound, and words are used, independently and in combination, to create meaning. It explores the use and significance of particular conventions and techniques in the media and considers the roles of the viewer and the producer in constructing meaning in media texts. Students apply the knowledge and skills gained through analysis of media texts as they create their own texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

In the specific expectations in this strand, the examples and sample questions refer to media forms and conventions that are appropriate for instruction in the given course. These are not, however, the only forms and conventions that students may explore in the course. Teachers will continue to use their professional judgement to decide on the forms and conventions students will study, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms.

THE RESEARCH AND INQUIRY PROCESS

Educators are encouraged to refer to the general discussion of the research and inquiry process that appears in the introduction to this document (see page 24) for necessary information relating to all First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies courses. Inquiry and research are at the heart of learning in “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices”. They are incorporated into all the strands as students locate, question, and validate information through a rigorous process of interpretation and reflection in oral communication, reading, writing, and media studies. Students develop their ability to ask questions more deeply or thoughtfully and to explore a variety of possible answers to those questions.

English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices, Grade 11

University Preparation

NBE3U

This course explores the themes, forms, and stylistic elements of a variety of literary, informational, graphic, oral, cultural, and media text forms emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in Canada, and also examines the perspectives and influence of texts that relate to those cultures. In order to fully understand contemporary text forms and their themes of identity, relationship, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, students will analyse the changing use of text forms by Indigenous authors/creators from various periods and cultures in expressing ideas related to these themes. Students will also create oral, written, and media texts to explore their own ideas and understanding, focusing on the development of literacy, communication, and critical and creative thinking skills necessary for success in academic and daily life. The course is intended to prepare students for the compulsory Grade 12 English university or college preparation course.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 10, Academic

A. FIRST NATIONS, MÉTIS, AND INUIT PERSPECTIVES AND TEXT FORMS IN CANADA

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore themes related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in text forms created in Canada, formulating questions and comparing perspectives to stimulate a well-reasoned exchange of ideas about these topics;
- A2. Deconstructing:** demonstrate an understanding of how representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and cultures in text forms created in Canada are influenced by perspectives related to or shaped by historical period, cultural background, and social and political conditions and events, including perspectives related to gender and the role of women;
- A3. Reconstructing:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of contemporary and historical text forms created in Canada in representing the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit lives, cultures, and world views, and assess the impact on Canadian society of efforts to challenge colonialist views and incomplete or inaccurate representations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

Identifying Text Forms

- A1.1** identify various cultural text forms* and associated customs from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and explain how they support the communication of meaning within the society (e.g., *birch bark scrolls used by Anishinaabe communities to record events, stories, migration patterns, and cultural teachings form a collective history of a people; a buffalo-hide robe painted with symbols representing life events is an autobiographical text form that conveys family history; Northwest Coast Tsimshian button blankets are decorated with patterns made from mother-of-pearl buttons to represent an individual's clan; Inuit women engage in katajjaq, or throat singing, producing rhythmic patterns of voiced and*

unvoiced sounds through inhalation or exhalation, as an entertainment or in some cases to soothe babies; ceremonial and traditional clothing incorporates nation-affiliated symbols and/or traditional designs to allow wearers to express their cultural identity)

Sample questions: “Why is it important to have a record of the spirit and intent of an agreement between two parties? What barriers can get in the way of interpreting a written contractual agreement? How does the use of a wampum belt as the text of a contractual agreement change your view of agreements? How does it change your definition of text?”

Formulating Questions

- A1.2** formulate increasingly effective questions to guide their explorations of themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit

* The term “cultural text form” is used in this document to refer to forms and means of communication – including, for example, elements of material culture, such as clothing and regalia; stories; songs, music, dances; and cultural practices – that have developed over time on the basis of the beliefs and values of the culture and that are respected, honoured, and passed on from generation to generation to express and communicate those shared beliefs and values. These forms employ various symbols, practices, images, sounds, and/or concrete forms to convey information and ideas. See [page 188](#) for background information and a chart identifying various types of cultural text forms.

identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., factual question: “What are some issues related to the legal status of the Two Row Wampum Treaty?”; comparative question: “What are some similarities and differences between First Nations, Métis, or Inuit accounts of the creation of the world and those of other cultures?”; causal question: “What are some consequences of the ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures have been represented in history, science, and geography texts written for Canadian schools?”)

Sample questions: “What is an inquiry stance? How can you apply an inquiry stance to support your learning about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives in an English course?”

Exploring Identities

A1.3 identify and explain diverse themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., with reference to cultural identities, legal identification in Canada, self-identification and related terminology, the link between identity and traditional territories, individual roles and responsibilities within clan family structures)

Sample questions: “Why do you think the theme of the extended family often occurs in Inuit text forms and literature related to Inuit culture? What does that reflect about Inuit concepts of individual versus collective identity?” “In what ways have Métis individuals and communities been affected by being dispossessed of their homelands? How are these effects reflected in Métis text forms? What do you think some consequences might be of feeling the need both to hide and to reclaim Métis identity?”

Exploring Relationships

A1.4 identify and explain diverse themes, ideas, and issues associated with relationships in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., with reference to the interconnectedness of all living things, the rights and responsibilities derived from natural law that shape the relationship between humankind and nature, ancestral relations between the spirit world and families, the relationship between Aboriginal title and treaty rights and human rights and freedoms, the connection between familial ties and community ties)

Sample questions: “What specifically Inuit perspective on the relationship between the natural and human worlds does this song convey?” “In the novel you are studying, what aspects of the narrator’s perspective on the interconnectedness of all living things reflect an authentic First Nation world view?” “How does this poem convey the uniqueness of Métis culture while illustrating its relationship to First Nations and European cultures and to the fur trader way of life?”

Exploring Self-Determination, Sovereignty, and Self-Governance

A1.5 identify and explain diverse themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., with reference to nation-to-nation relations, land claim disputes and resolutions, traditional territories, linguistic and cultural revitalization, citizenship, colonialist policies, the principles of the Two Row Wampum)

Sample questions: “Do the various informational narratives and reports you have read express an equitable relationship between Indigenous and non-Indigenous governments with respect to Indigenous rights? Why, or why not?”

Comparing Perspectives

A1.6 compare multiple perspectives on themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various texts from both Indigenous and non-Indigenous sources (e.g., compare perspectives on the role of society in family affairs presented in the Two Row Times, Nunatsiak News, or Métis Voyageur and in one or more mainstream newspapers; identify how the perspectives on the commoditization or protection of natural resources such as seeds, water, soil, and air presented in a variety of texts contradict or confirm one another)

Sample questions: “How might the perspective of a research report on the history and contemporary context of the Métis Nation vary depending on the sources it is drawn from?” “How would you characterize the perspectives of these two magazine articles on treaty processes and treaty relationships in Canada? Do they contradict or confirm one another?” “What are some similarities and differences between the way these two novels approach the theme of a First Nation family’s spiritual ties to its ancestors?”

A2. Deconstructing

Throughout this course, students will:

Viewpoint

A2.1 determine how the messages relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures conveyed in various contemporary and historical Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in non-Indigenous texts, might change if they were presented from a range of different perspectives (e.g., *the perspectives of contemporary federal politicians, Métis community leaders, First Nations women affected by gender discrimination in the Indian Act, children in residential school, women whose lives are depicted in the text, settlers, priests*), and make appropriate inferences about how the viewpoint of the creator/author is shaped by factors related to historical period, gender, culture, sexual orientation, ability, and/or politics

Sample questions: “What viewpoint did the author want to express about the topic? Who benefits from the perspectives expressed in this text?” “How might this text have been different if First Nations, Métis, and Inuit women’s voices had been included or better represented?” “Why is it important to interpret text forms related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures from various perspectives, using a range of analytical approaches?”

Contradictions

A2.2 identify contradictions in how First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures have been depicted in various contemporary and historical Indigenous text forms, and non-Indigenous texts (e.g., “noble” and “philosophical” versus “uncivilized” “savages”, *sovereign nations versus wards of the government, economically diverse versus impoverished, spiritually rich versus irreligious*), and analyse the reasons for the divergence of views

Sample questions: “Do you think this editorial response in a mainstream newspaper to an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities is accurate, fair, and complete? Why, or why not? How might it contradict an authentic First Nations, Métis, or Inuit response to the issue? How do you explain these differences in perspective?” “What contradiction underlies the concept of the ‘noble savage’ as depicted in some mid-twentieth-century movies?” “What are some factors that have helped change depictions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals in text forms in Canada over time?”

Positioning

A2.3 make inferences of increasing subtlety about attitudes towards First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content in various contemporary and historical text forms, providing explanations that draw on a range of appropriate evidence to support their opinions (e.g., *relative amount and prominence of material; placement of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit content in relation to other content; integration of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit content into, and/or degree of relevance to, the main theme or argument of the text; reliance on primary or secondary sources of information*)

Accessibility

A2.4 describe a range of contemporary and historical factors affecting public access to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms, including cultural text forms (e.g., *the role and reasoning of the courts in regulating First Nations, Métis, and Inuit self-expression in the nineteenth and first half of the twentieth century; the number of people with knowledge of writing systems, such as the Inuktitut syllabic system, that are used in various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms; the number of speakers of Indigenous languages used in various oral text forms; the role and reasoning of Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, and/or knowledge holders in protecting traditional and/or sacred knowledge*)

Asymmetries

A2.5 describe a range of issues related to attempts to apply Western cultural criteria to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms, including cultural text forms (e.g., *issues arising from copyright law and notions of individual ownership of cultural products; the privileging of Western text forms, such as print, over other forms, such as oral expression; non-Indigenous appropriation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit traditional knowledge*)

Sample questions: “What do non-Indigenous writers and publishers need to consider in relation to truth, sensitivity, and respect when they collect and publish stories that draw on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit knowledge, oral stories, and cultures? In what specific ways can applying Western cultural criteria to artistic and cultural expression lead to the appropriation of Indigenous knowledge?”

A3. Reconstructing

Throughout this course, students will:

Acknowledging

A3.1 demonstrate an understanding of the challenges First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities face and have faced in controlling their own narratives and resisting colonialist views, as revealed in text forms studied in this course (*e.g., identify, in nineteenth- and early-twentieth-century text forms, representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and cultures that reflect unquestioning acceptance and perpetuation of negative stereotypes; explain how contemporary graphic novels by some First Nations, Métis, and Inuit authors demonstrate cultural resistance to colonialist views*)

Sample questions: “How can identifying misrepresentations in historical or contemporary text forms encourage more accurate representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities?” “In what ways does this narrative attempt to reassert a Métis perspective on subject matter related to Métis communities?” “How does this text question a colonialist view of Inuit life?”

Naming

A3.2 identify appropriate ways to refer to Indigenous peoples in diverse contexts (*e.g., judicial and legislative terminology, treaty language, global forums, historical narratives, personal communications that reflect individual naming preferences, texts relating to contemporary local communities*), and locate examples of inappropriate terminology in contemporary and historical text forms from both Indigenous and non-Indigenous sources and explain the significance of naming choices

Sample questions: “In what ways is naming particularly problematic for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in Canada?” “How does knowledge of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit history help you appreciate the need to use appropriate terms in your own writing?” “As you read the terms used in contemporary written texts to describe various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, how do you think they affect your comprehension of the message?” “What is your reaction to the use of the words ‘Indian’, ‘half-breed’, or ‘Eskimo’ instead of ‘First Nation’, ‘Métis’, or ‘Inuit’ to refer to Indigenous peoples in Canada? What contexts can you think of in which such usage

might be justified or even required (for example, direct quotations from historical documents or dialogue consistent with the speaker’s character and the period in historical novels)?”

Diversity

A3.3 analyse and compare the ways in which the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit lives, knowledge, cultures, and world views is represented or under-represented in various contemporary and historical text forms (*e.g., compare depictions of a specific First Nation, Métis, or Inuit culture in a contemporary documentary and a mid-twentieth-century documentary to determine how accurately the culture is differentiated from other cultures in each case; describe some ways in which contemporary Indigenous authors such as Richard Wagamese and Eden Robinson have shaped literary representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit diversity; describe how the use of words such as ‘Aboriginal’, ‘Indian’, and ‘Indigenous’ in historical text forms might undermine the concept of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit diversity, and explain the challenge this represents for contemporary historians*)

Sample questions: “Given the widespread use of the word ‘Indian’ in earlier centuries to refer to diverse groups of Indigenous people in North America, what strategies can contemporary historians and writers use to differentiate each nation’s contribution to Canadian history?” “How does this text written in the mid-twentieth century about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms compare to one written in the early twenty-first century? In your opinion, how does the change in the way that the art forms and their origins are described affect the reader’s understanding of the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures?”

Relevance

A3.4 evaluate a variety of contemporary text forms to determine how accurately they represent the lives and activities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, past and present (*e.g., compare how the political interests of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit voters are depicted in the media by Indigenous and non-Indigenous media sources; assess the currency of information about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities in various history textbooks; compare various literary portrayals of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and cultures by Indigenous and non-Indigenous writers*), and explain, with increasing insight, how updated representations can influence society (*e.g., television programs representing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit*

individuals engaged in a wide range of activities and careers broaden awareness of contemporary lifestyles; new textbook editions reflecting current perspectives on historical events involving First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities ensure that misconceptions are not perpetuated; short stories and poetry by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit authors raise awareness of continued injustices and inequalities, and of the significance of cultural revitalization)

Sample questions: “In your opinion, how well do Indigenous and non-Indigenous media sources reflect the political interests of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities? In what ways do Indigenous and non-Indigenous media representations differ from one another? How might these differences affect the way non-Indigenous Canadians view First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations?”

Affirmation

A3.5 describe various contemporary efforts to affirm the value and counteract the under-valuation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural text forms (e.g., as texts of foundational importance with respect to world views rather than artefacts or crafts; as historical records rather than legends; as affirmations of the interconnectedness of humans and the natural world rather than myths), and analyse the influence of these efforts on society

Sample questions: “How do labels such as ‘legend’, ‘myth’, and ‘artefact’ attached to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms make it more difficult for individuals to understand and value First Nations, Métis, and Inuit belief systems appropriately?” “What can you learn about Indigenous beliefs from campaigns for the return of medicine bundles and other culturally sensitive materials currently stored in Canadian museums to the communities that produced them? What consequences might such repatriation have?” “How do the sacred spaces being created in some urban school environments, such as medicine wheel gardens, traditional food and plant gardens, and mural gardens, respectfully support and reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit spirituality, teachings, and symbols?”

B. ORAL COMMUNICATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Oral Tradition:** demonstrate an understanding of text forms, figures, and practices associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explaining how these traditions communicate meaning and how they are used in contemporary communities, and demonstrate the use of culturally appropriate listening practices;
- B2. Listening to Understand:** listen to oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in order to understand and respond appropriately in a variety of situations for a variety of purposes;
- B3. Speaking to Communicate:** use speaking skills and strategies appropriately to communicate with different audiences, for a variety of purposes, about themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- B4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as listeners and speakers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in oral communication contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Oral Tradition

By the end of this course, students will:

Oral Text Forms and Their Use

- B1.1** identify various text forms associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures; explain their purpose and symbolic meaning (e.g., *reiterative storytelling affirms the spirit and intent of the teaching through repetition and variation; creation stories offer a spiritual foundation for human life and explain the relationship between humanity and the natural world; acknowledgements are simple greetings that are exchanged in recognition of the speakers' family and clan connections; spiritual or traditional names offered by speakers when they introduce themselves affirm the connection between the person, his or her community, and the spiritual realm*); and describe various customs governing their use (e.g., *protocols determined by the time of year or the age of the listener govern the sharing of stories about seasonal change or the transition from one life stage to the next; cultural norms assign the task of oral teaching to Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, and knowledge holders; storytellers have specific roles and responsibilities within a particular culture*;

metaphor is used to develop listeners' deeper thinking; culturally specific practices ensure the preservation, maintenance, and accuracy of stories; humour is used to engage listeners)

Sample questions: "Why are Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, and knowledge holders assigned the task of oral teaching? In what specific ways do they protect and preserve traditional teachings?" "Do you think the protection of oral tradition and special status for knowledge holders such as Elders remain relevant in contemporary society? Why, or why not?"

Figures and Their Function

- B1.2** describe a variety of significant figures from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit oral stories (e.g., *Chikapash, Nuliajuk or Sedna, Kiviuk, Waynaboozhoo or Nanabush, Great Spirit or Creator, Mother Earth, clan animals, Windigo*), including their origins, roles, characteristics, and behaviour, and explain, with increasing insight, how they reflect a particular culture's world view (e.g., *Sedna's vengeful character defines the relationship between Inuit and the sea; Coyote's use of humour and trickery provokes thoughtful contemplation of how various aspects of the natural world have come to be*;

Waynaboozhoo's shape-shifting spirit demonstrates to the Anishinaabe people how to live in harmony with nature)

Sample questions: “What are tricksters? How do trickster figures interact with humans in oral stories? What is the purpose of their trickery?” “What aspects of [the culture’s] world view are explained by the behaviour of the figures in this story?” “What traits does Coyote share with Raven? What does that suggest about [the culture’s] world view?” “Which figures can you identify who mediate between life and death?”

Societal Influences

B1.3 explain, with increasing insight, the influence of a range of social, economic, and/or political forces (e.g., colonization, forced relocation, cultural and political oppression, decolonization, cultural revitalization, territorial disputes and resulting court decisions regarding oral history, the erosion of social structures that support oral knowledge transmission as a result of changing lifestyles, the evolving legal definition of intellectual property) on the disruption or continuation of oral traditions in contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “In what ways do you think laws governing intellectual property rights, digital media, and the writing process have affected the role of oral traditions in contemporary First Nations and Métis sharing circles?” “What role has oral history played in court decisions regarding territorial disputes? What is the current legal status of oral history in the courts?” “What are some cultural revitalization efforts aimed specifically at supporting the continuation of oral traditions?”

Culturally Appropriate Listening Practices

B1.4 select and use culturally appropriate listening practices during oral teachings by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit speakers (e.g., refrain from interrupting to clarify a point unless invited to do so by the Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder who is giving the teaching; make a mental note of key points while listening to deduce the lesson of the teaching; make personal connections to the content of a story to develop meaning from a traditional teaching; refrain from taking notes, making a recording, or reproducing a teaching without explicit permission from the traditional knowledge holder and/or community)

Sample questions: “Why might it be inappropriate to make an audio or video recording of an oral teaching or to take notes while an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder is talking? How do the members of a

culture ensure that such protocols are understood by all? How do these restrictions affect the transmission of traditional knowledge and skills from one generation to the next?”

B2. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

B2.1 identify the purpose of a range of listening tasks, with a focus on listening to oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and set goals for specific tasks (e.g., to note the cultural terminology used by a presenter; to determine the merits of a viewpoint before providing a response in a discussion; to gather suggestions for improvement during a student-teacher conference; to identify a life lesson from the oral teaching of an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder; to take effective notes while listening to a lecture; to develop patience, trust, and empathy through repeated listening to oral stories)

Sample questions: “What are you expecting to learn from this speaker?” “How do you determine which points in the presentation represent the speaker’s perspective rather than describing substantive facts?” “Why is it important to pay attention to your emotions while listening to an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder speak?”

Using Active Listening Strategies

B2.2 select and use the most appropriate active listening strategies when interacting in a range of oral communication contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., formulate questions to help them understand the viewpoint of a speaker; ask a speaker to clarify historical details, such as a reference to non-interference and the Two Row Wampum Treaty; respond to a speaker’s viewpoint while showing respect for diverse ideas and cultural perspectives; affirm and build on the contributions of others in a small-group discussion)

Sample questions: “What does it mean to disagree respectfully?” “What beliefs or attitudes do you hold that could hinder your willingness to consider the speaker’s viewpoint? What are some listening strategies that might help you listen with an open mind?”

Using Listening Comprehension Strategies

B2.3 select and use the most appropriate listening comprehension strategies before, during, and after listening to understand oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit

cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts (*e.g., review background materials that present a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit perspective before listening to a debate on a related topic; refer to their own research to facilitate or confirm their understanding of an oral teaching by an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder*)

Sample questions: “How did your research on the world view of this cultural group help you understand the debaters’ viewpoints?” “What questions could you prepare before listening to a news report about an event within a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community? How is it helpful to identify key verbs in the report that are used to describe the actions the community is taking?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

B2.4 identify, in a variety of ways, important information and ideas in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts (*e.g., identify recurring themes in a variety of presentations on an issue related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures; identify evidence in an oral text that substantiates the text’s central claim; create a musical compilation that supports the message and tone of a dramatic reading about the history of a First Nation community*)

Sample questions: “What similar important ideas did the presentations make? What ideas did they disagree on?” “What theme(s) emerged from the presentations?”

Interpreting Texts

B2.5 develop and explain interpretations of oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, using evidence from the text, including oral and visual cues, to support their interpretations effectively (*e.g., explain how the speaker’s selection of supporting details in a seminar on contemporary Inuit communities affected their interpretation of the message; explain the challenges to Métis identity outlined and solutions proposed by a guest speaker, identifying how the speaker’s use of anecdotes, repetition, and tone of voice helped them to interpret the message; describe similarities and differences between two singers’ interpretations of the same song lyrics, identifying non-verbal cues that support those interpretations*)

Sample questions: “What information did the speaker’s tone of voice convey about his or her attitude to the topic? How did that affect your interpretation of the message?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

B2.6 extend their understanding of oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, by making effective connections between the ideas in them and in other texts and to their own knowledge, experience, and insights (*e.g., compare and contrast the values expressed in a traditional oral teaching with their own beliefs; connect the issues discussed in a public forum about on-reserve First Nations youth to their own and their peers’ experience*)

Sample questions: “In what ways did your experience of learning another language or your heritage language help you understand the Elder’s oral report on the challenges of promoting the use of Indigenous languages in First Nations communities? What questions do you still have about the Elder’s main points that other oral texts might help you answer?”

Analysing Texts

B2.7 analyse oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, focusing on the ways in which they communicate information, themes, ideas, and issues and influence the listener’s/viewer’s response (*e.g., describe how a speaker’s use of non-verbal cues in a presentation about Canada’s shared history with Indigenous peoples influenced their response to the message; explain how the Crown–Indigenous Relations and Northern Affairs critic used particular figures of speech during Question Period in the House of Commons to influence their audience; analyse the use of “expert opinions” to establish authority in a news broadcast about an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities*)

Sample questions: “What figures of speech did the Official Opposition’s Crown–Indigenous Relations and Northern Affairs critic use during Question Period? What do you think was the intended effect? Do you think the language was chosen primarily to persuade the minister and other MPs, visitors in the public gallery, the press, or the television audience? What reasons can you give for your opinion?”

Critical Literacy

B2.8 identify and analyse the perspectives and/or biases evident in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, and comment with growing understanding on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (*e.g., identify the perspective of a speaker discussing the impact of*

proposed government legislation on Indigenous sovereignty or self-governance and predict how people with different perspectives might react; identify any omission of relevant information in an oral report on missing and murdered Indigenous women in Canada and explain how the inclusion of those facts might affect the viewpoint being presented)

Sample questions: “What viewpoint is represented in this oral text? Is any important information omitted in order to sustain the viewpoint? Whose interests are served by this perspective?” “Whose voice is left out of this presentation? How can you find out about other perspectives?”

Understanding Presentation Strategies

B2.9 evaluate the effectiveness of a variety of presentation strategies used in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, and suggest other strategies that could be used effectively (e.g., *describe a First Nation leader’s change of tone when addressing a provincial premier and explain what makes it effective; identify and assess the effectiveness of the strategies a politician used to establish respect in a speech to an Inuit community; evaluate how effectively and respectfully a group used costumes and props to engage the audience during a presentation*)

Sample questions: “How well did the organizational structure of the presentation support the group’s argument? What could the presenters have done differently to improve the presentation?” “Which visual aid was the most effective at reinforcing the subject matter? How did it do so?” “What are some types of presentation that might benefit from using audience participation?”

B3. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

B3.1 orally communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives for a range of purposes, using language and following social codes appropriate for the intended purpose and audience (e.g., *deliver a presentation about local history, beginning by acknowledging the Indigenous peoples of the territory under discussion; participate in a sharing circle, providing examples of their life experiences when introducing themselves; tell a traditional story to an audience of young children, using simple, vivid language; participate*

in a panel discussion on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit educational initiatives; host a seminar analysing a play by a contemporary First Nation, Métis, or Inuk playwright; stage a mock trial of Louis Riel, presenting arguments from both sides of the case)

Sample questions: “How could you adapt a traditional oral text to present it to an audience of young children?” “How can you effectively incorporate terms used in literary analysis into your seminar?”

Interpersonal Speaking Strategies

B3.2 demonstrate an understanding of a variety of interpersonal speaking strategies, and adapt them effectively to suit the purpose, situation, and audience, exhibiting sensitivity to cultural differences (e.g., *contribute to and lead productive group discussions; allow sufficient time for differences of opinion to be expressed in the audience-response portion of a presentation; use language that all participants in a seminar will understand*)

Sample questions: “What speaking strategies can you use to encourage other participants in a group to think about contentious issues in new ways?” “What strategies can you use to encourage other speakers to express their opinions openly?”

Clarity and Coherence

B3.3 orally communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives in a clear, coherent manner, using a structure and style effective for the purpose, subject matter, and intended audience (e.g., *select and use relevant information from research to support key points in a presentation; use a variety of examples to support an oral argument; refer to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit text forms to support and clarify the information in an oral presentation about the traditional knowledge and world view associated with a particular culture; select and use appropriate strategies to respond to audience needs*)

Sample questions: “What is the most effective order of key points in your group presentation to ensure that your audience follows the argument?” “What examples can you incorporate into your presentation to make your argument more effective?”

Diction and Devices

B3.4 use appropriate words, phrases, and terminology, and a variety of stylistic devices, to communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives effectively and to engage

their intended audience (e.g., select words that are relevant to their topic, such as the names of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and significant individuals, and pronounce them correctly when delivering a presentation; use metaphors and analogies to enhance the message of a speech; use rhetorical questions to engage their audience and to spark small- or large-group discussions)

Sample questions: “How will this metaphor engage your listeners?” “How could you change your diction to evoke the character in the role play more effectively?” “How might you effectively embed humour into your oral presentation?”

Vocal Strategies

B3.5 identify a variety of vocal strategies, including tone, pace, pitch, and volume, and use them effectively and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences (e.g., use a calm tone in a debate to maintain a non-adversarial atmosphere when expressing an opposing view; adjust pitch and volume to ensure that their audience can hear clearly; clearly enunciate words to communicate the nuances of their message)

Sample questions: “How can you use context clues such as audience, subject matter, and intention to determine the appropriate volume for speaking? What examples can you give?” “How might you use silences to communicate meaning in an oral presentation?”

Non-Verbal Cues

B3.6 identify a variety of non-verbal cues, including facial expressions, gestures, and eye contact, and use them effectively and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences to help convey their meaning (e.g., use body language, physical proximity, and gestures that are culturally appropriate to their audience; identify an interviewer’s use of non-verbal cues to determine their effectiveness and applicability, and use them when conducting their own interviews; use facial expressions that convey impartiality when presenting information that their audience may find controversial or surprising)

Sample question: “What background knowledge enables you to determine the types of non-verbal communication that are appropriate for you to use in a discussion with peers?”

Audio-Visual Aids

B3.7 use a variety of audio-visual aids effectively to support and enhance oral presentations on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and to engage their intended audience (e.g., incorporate interactive elements

into a presentation to encourage audience involvement; use visual materials such as photographs and video clips to illustrate key points; use sound recordings of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit speakers to support a presentation on Indigenous oral traditions)

Sample question: “How can you ensure that your audio-visual materials are a support rather than a distraction?”

B4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

B4.1 explain which of a variety of strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after listening to and speaking about texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, then evaluate their areas of greater and lesser strength in oral communication and identify the steps they can take to improve their skills (e.g., explain how they adapt their participation strategies to the context in culturally diverse groups; set specific goals for raising their current oral communication knowledge and skills, and keep a personal journal to monitor their progress; plan to improve their presentation skills by identifying effective strategies and skills used by other presenters)

Sample questions: “How does rehearsing the pronunciation of unfamiliar words help both you and your intended audience?” “What strategies do you see others using that you could adapt to strengthen your oral presentation skills?”

Interconnected Skills

B4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in reading, writing, viewing, and representing, and explain, with increasing insight, how these skills help them interpret and discuss oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (e.g., describe various ways in which viewing muted videos of debates and interviews helps them improve their use of body language and facial expressions when speaking; explain how reading background material about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural protocols helps them select and use appropriate listening skills during oral teachings)

Sample question: “How has the knowledge of cultural diversity you have gained from reading texts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures made you a better listener?”

C. READING AND LITERATURE STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading for Meaning:** read and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of literary, informational, and graphic texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, using a range of strategies to construct meaning;
- C2. Understanding Form and Style:** identify a variety of text forms, text features, and stylistic elements in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and demonstrate an understanding of how they help communicate meaning;
- C3. Reading with Fluency:** use knowledge of words and cueing systems to read fluently;
- C4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as readers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources;
- C5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Literature:** identify various contributions of individuals, organizations, and initiatives, including technological initiatives, to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature, and analyse the social and cultural influence of those contributions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- C1.1** read a variety of student- and teacher-selected contemporary texts from diverse First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources and historical texts, identifying specific purposes for reading (e.g., *to compare their own perspective on a topic with the perspective of the main character in a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit work of fiction; to identify ways in which elements such as the thesis statement, structure, and stylistic features of an essay on an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities can serve as a model for their own writing; to compare treatments of similar themes in texts from diverse First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures*)

Sample questions: “What stylistic elements of the essay did you find effective? Why? How might you incorporate similar features into your own writing?” “What do you hope to learn by comparing various creation stories?”

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- C1.2** select and use the most appropriate reading comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading to understand texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts (e.g., *compare two or more accounts of an historical event, written from different perspectives, to identify information gaps and inaccurate assumptions about First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals and communities in a novel set in the past; use a graphic organizer to record and clarify the messages in an essay on an issue of importance to a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community*)

Sample questions: “How has your research on Métis life in the nineteenth century prepared you for reading the novel? What further information do you need in order to visualize the setting?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

C1.3 identify the most important ideas and supporting details in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts (*e.g., outline various definitions of sovereignty or self-governance explored in a poem; explain what the subheadings in an essay reveal about the writer's attitude to the events described; create a mind map to illustrate character relationships in a short story or novel with a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit setting*)

Sample question: “What key facts in the story support the author’s interpretation of events?”

Making Inferences

C1.4 make and explain inferences of increasing subtlety about texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, supporting their explanations with well-chosen stated and implied ideas from the texts (*e.g., explain how the narrative voice supports the text's message about the nature of social and spiritual relationships; explain what the table of contents of a magazine suggests about the target audience; explain how the introduction to a novel foreshadows certain events in the plot*)

Sample questions: “What do the layout and typography of this poem contribute to its meaning?” “What details in the introduction to this historical novel about the Métis Nation convey the austerity of life in the nineteenth century?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

C1.5 extend their understanding of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, by making rich connections between the ideas in them and in other texts and to their own knowledge, experience, and insights (*e.g., compare the ways in which the beliefs and values of a fictional character shape his or her response to a crisis with their own probable reactions in similar circumstances; apply their knowledge of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit traditions to identify and explain symbolic elements of a novel; identify similarities and differences between the ideas expressed in an editorial on a current issue related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and the ideas on the same topic expressed in at least two other texts*)

Sample questions: “How does your knowledge of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit spirituality help you understand the narrative?” “How is the thesis of this essay supported by Elders’

teachings, academic storywork, and/or First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views?”

Analysing Texts

C1.6 analyse texts, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, in terms of the information, themes, ideas, and issues they explore in relation to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explaining with increasing insight how various aspects of the texts contribute to the presentation or development of these elements (*e.g., explain how the poem's theme of spirit as a life force is reinforced through repetition, diction, and choice of images; trace the evolving moral or spiritual values of a character through the development of a story; explain why internal conflict frequently appears in novels with central First Nations, Métis, and Inuit characters, and identify aspects of the characterization in a particular novel that heighten the expression of this theme*)

Sample questions: “How do the metaphors in this poem reinforce the ideas about identity that the poem expresses?” “How does the structure of the story reflect the character’s spiritual journey?”

Evaluating Texts

C1.7 evaluate the effectiveness of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, using evidence from the text to support their opinions (*e.g., evaluate the effectiveness of a text on the basis of specific criteria, such as authenticity of setting, psychological depth of portrayals of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit characters, and accuracy of cultural information; evaluate how effectively the visual elements of a graphic novel featuring a First Nation protagonist contribute to the satirical intent; evaluate the historical accuracy of a biography of a prominent First Nation, Métis, or Inuk figure by researching reliable sources; compare the relationship between humans and the natural world expressed in a selection of short stories, and explain why they consider one treatment of the theme to be more effective than the others*)

Sample questions: “In what ways does the author’s use of dialogue reveal character more effectively than a third-person description could? What kinds of information can dialogue give that could not be readily conveyed through a third-person description? What kinds of information could a third-person description give that is not communicated through the dialogue?” “Was the use of flashback an effective way to explain the factors that influenced the central character’s choices? What other techniques could the author have used? Do you think they would have been as effective? Why, or why not?”

Critical Literacy

C1.8 identify and analyse the perspectives and/or biases evident in texts dealing with themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, commenting with growing understanding on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *explain, on the basis of research, how the historical and/or cultural context of a novel accounts for the social values expressed by its characters; compare the perspectives on an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities expressed in editorials or feature articles in different newspapers and magazines; identify the perspective implied in a historical treaty and explain how it supports or undermines the power of the signatory parties*)

Sample questions: “What groups are most prominent in this historical account of colonization? What groups are marginalized or ignored? Why do you think this is?” “What social and legal conditions of this period might help explain the actions, attitudes, and treatment of women represented in this text?” “How do the political perspectives expressed in these newspapers differ?” “What social perspective on First Nations, Métis, or Inuit identities is expressed in the text? What does that suggest about the author’s beliefs and values?”

C2. Understanding Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Text Forms

C2.1 identify a variety of characteristics of literary, informational, and graphic text forms, and explain, with increasing insight, how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view (e.g., *the choice of narrator affects the tone and content of a historical narrative; a parody achieves a satirical effect by using a serious tone to describe an absurd situation; the structure of an epic poem or a narrative text can reflect the stages of the archetypal heroic quest; the organization of a persuasive essay can be used to build an argument*)

Sample questions: “How might the ideas and themes expressed by the various design elements of a wampum belt be conveyed in an informational text? What might be lost – or gained – by using a written form of expression?” “How does the choice of narrator in this story affect the reader’s perception of Métis perspectives on the subject matter?”

Text Features

C2.2 identify a variety of features of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and explain, with increasing insight, how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view (e.g., *describe the type of information that captioned photographs add to a report on Inuit communities; explain how the layout or punctuation of a poem on the theme of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit spirituality adds to its meaning or emotional impact; identify how fonts are used to reflect the different characters in a graphic novel*)

Sample questions: “How do the illustrations in this report on Inuit communities enhance the information supplied by the text? What new ideas do they add?” “How does this infographic support the Métis perspectives expressed in this newspaper article? Is it effective? Why, or why not?” “How does the layout of this poem add to its emotional impact?”

Elements of Style

C2.3 identify a variety of elements of style in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and explain, with increasing insight, how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view and enhance the effectiveness of the text (e.g., *explain how the use of first-person narrative in a novel enhances its theme about relationships with ancestral spirits; analyse how the diction used to describe First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals in a news report or characters in a story affects the message; explain the function of hyperbole in a satirical essay or play script about life in a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit community*)

Sample questions: “How does the use of alliteration help convey the main character’s feelings about the challenges he or she faces?” “How does the diction the author uses to describe nature and the weather reflect or enhance the theme of the story?” “How does the playwright infuse the play script with humour and philosophy to engage the audience on a topic of concern to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?” “Why do you think the author uses hyperbole in the essay? How does it affect your response as a reader?”

C3. Reading with Fluency

By the end of this course, students will:

Reading Familiar Words

C3.1 demonstrate an automatic understanding of most words in a variety of reading contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *read with understanding vocabulary used in grade-level texts on topics of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, words used figuratively in literary texts, and slang words used in fiction and non-fiction texts; identify the origin of a word commonly used in the context of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit cultures and trace the evolution of its meaning*)

Sample questions: “How are the words ‘decolonization’ and ‘settler Canadian’ defined in the texts you are reading in class?” “The words ‘Indian’, ‘Indigenous’, and ‘Aboriginal’ are familiar but their meaning can be ambiguous. What are some concerns they raise in various reading contexts?”

Reading Unfamiliar Words

C3.2 use decoding strategies effectively to read and understand unfamiliar words, including words of increasing difficulty, in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, in relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources (e.g., *use an etymological dictionary to identify the original and evolving meanings of new words; use a glossary of literary terms to decode unfamiliar words encountered in literary criticism*)

Sample question: “The dictionary provides several different meanings for this word. How can you use context to determine which meaning applies in this poem?”

Developing Vocabulary

C3.3 use a variety of strategies, with increasing regularity, to explore and expand vocabulary (e.g., *refer to specialized resources such as dictionaries; identify various ways to refer to the same cultural group and determine the most appropriate in contemporary contexts*), focusing on words and phrases that have particular significance for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities (e.g., *nation, self-governance, sovereignty, identity/identities, non-status, band, Indian, Aboriginal, Indigenous, Haudenosaunee, Cree, Métis, minority group, special interest group, Elder, treaty, residential school*) and evaluating the precision with which these words are used in the texts they are reading

Sample questions: “Why might the word ‘adopted’ be difficult for Inuit families to interpret? What aspects of Inuit tradition make

the concepts of step-children and adopted children foreign to the culture?”

C4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

C4.1 explain which of a variety of strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, then evaluate their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers and identify the steps they can take to improve their skills (e.g., *record their reflections about how often and how proficiently they use various reading strategies, and set targets for improving their use of strategies that have been less effective; confer with the teacher to develop new strategies for understanding more challenging texts*)

Sample questions: “What pre-reading strategy did you use before starting your independent reading of the novel? Did it help you to make sense of the introduction? Why, or why not?” “How did small-group discussions influence the predictions you made about the story? How might you improve your use of small-group discussions?”

Interconnected Skills

C4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, writing, viewing, and representing, and explain, with increasing insight, how these skills help them read texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (e.g., *explain specific ways in which their knowledge of how to structure a piece of writing can help them analyse the structure of a text they are reading; identify the listening skills they drew on when reading a play script to interpret the tone of a character’s dialogue*)

Sample question: “How did staging a debate about the central argument of the text you read in class help you understand the issues raised in it?”

C5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Literature

By the end of this course, students will:

Development of Contemporary Literature

C5.1 describe the contributions of a variety of individuals, organizations, and initiatives to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature (e.g., individuals: *Thomas King, Rachel Attituq Qitsualik-Tinsley,*

Lee Maracle, Kateri Akiwenzie-Damm, Taqralik Partridge; organizations: the Ontario Native Literacy Coalition RIEL Centre, Indigenous- and non-Indigenous-owned publishing companies and booksellers, library associations; initiatives: Kimiwan zine, the Ânskohk Aboriginal Literature Festival, various book awards, book clubs that focus on works by Indigenous writers)

Sample questions: “How have Indigenous and non-Indigenous publishing houses supported the emergence of new First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers?” “What awards can you name that have helped raise public awareness of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature? Who are some of the recipients and what were their contributions?”

Influence of Contemporary Literature

C5.2 analyse the influence of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literary works on identities and heritage in Canada (e.g., in terms of offering alternative perspectives on historical events in Canada; of incorporating First Nations, Métis, and Inuit voices, world views, and identities into Canadian literary heritage; of shaping the content and delivery of postsecondary history and literature courses), commenting with increasing insight on the role of literature as a social and cultural force in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “What are some specific ways in which Basil Johnston’s works have contributed to linguistic and cultural revitalization in First Nations communities?” “What major themes are represented in the collective works gathered in *Honouring Indigenous Women: Hearts of Nations*, vol. 2? What event made the Toronto launch of the book especially significant?” “What are some specific benefits that contemporary Canadian society receives from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature?”

Influence of Technology

C5.3 analyse the role of technology in helping promote the work of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers and publishers, drawing on evidence from a variety of initiatives to support their conclusions (e.g., *Atlantic Canada’s First Nation Help Desk* offers video-conferencing and other technologies to help writers co-create community narratives and co-write publications; the *Historica Canada Indigenous Arts & Stories* competition for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth gives a start to emerging writers by sharing their work online; social media influencers use online chats and blog posts to review and promote new Indigenous literature)

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Developing and Organizing Content:** generate, gather, and organize ideas and information to write for an intended purpose and audience on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- D2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style:** draft and revise their writing, using a variety of literary, informational, and graphic forms and stylistic elements appropriate for the purpose and audience;
- D3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions:** use editing, proofreading, and publishing skills and strategies, and knowledge of language conventions, to correct errors, refine expression, and present their work effectively;
- D4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as writers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful at different stages of writing texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Developing and Organizing Content

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Topic, Purpose, and Audience

- D1.1** identify the topic, purpose, and audience for a variety of writing tasks on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (*e.g., an expository essay comparing the themes of two short stories or poems about family relationships in an Inuit community; a letter to the editor to rebut or endorse a news story about urban life as experienced by First Nations teens; an adaptation of a children's story to better reflect Métis life; a blog post about privilege and oppression, their effect on individuals and groups, and ways to address the consequences; a statement of personal commitment to reconciliation between Indigenous and non-Indigenous peoples*)

Sample questions: “Before you begin your letter to the editor, think about your audience. Are you writing for teens like those in the news story you are responding to, or for a more general audience? Do you want to persuade your readers to accept a new viewpoint, or to endorse the perspective of the original article?” “How would you dramatize an event in a story to appeal to an audience of children?”

Generating and Developing Ideas

- D1.2** generate, expand, explore, and focus ideas for potential writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate and with increasing effectiveness (*e.g., use a graphic organizer to group ideas and to help them determine the focus of an essay on symbolism in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit children's stories; after obtaining permission, make jot notes of ideas and questions arising during an oral teaching by an Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or knowledge holder for later reference in preparing in a written report; create a mind map or a Venn diagram to explore connections between the concepts they wish to express in a poem on the theme of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit sovereignty or self-governance; consult bibliographies and reference lists in books and periodicals, including e-books and e-journals, to identify potential sources of new information and ideas*)

Sample questions: “What questions would you like to investigate in preparing to write this essay?” “What have you identified as a possible thesis?”

Research

- D1.3** locate and select information to effectively support ideas for writing, using a variety of strategies and print, electronic, and other

resources, as appropriate (e.g., create a research plan and track their progress; identify a range of sources that contain material related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit customs and concerns; use keyword searches to locate online information relevant to their topic; create a detailed template to evaluate sources for relevance, reliability, viewpoint, and inclusive perspectives; record all sources of information, observing conventions for proper documentation, to ensure that all sources and extracts are fully acknowledged in their final piece of work)

Sample question: “What steps have you taken to ensure that you will be able to credit all research sources fully and accurately?”

Organizing Ideas

D1.4 identify, sort, and order main ideas and supporting details for writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and selecting the organizational pattern best suited to the content and the purpose for writing (e.g., reorganize the plot outline for a story to include a series of flashbacks; identify a pattern to guide their use of imagery in writing a poem; work in groups to sort and organize their ideas for writing a spoken-word story or poem, focusing on categories such as voice, power, and the depiction and/or exclusion of certain groups; use a graphic organizer to refine their ideas about a thesis or topic in preparation for writing a literary essay; determine the organizational pattern, such as chronological order, climactic order, or cause and effect, best suited to presenting ideas and information in an essay on a specific topic)

Sample questions: “How will you determine the best pattern of imagery to use in your poem?” “How will you organize the information you have gathered for your essay to best develop your thesis?”

Reviewing Content

D1.5 determine whether the ideas and information gathered are accurate and complete, interesting, and effectively meet the requirements of the writing task (e.g., draft a variety of opening statements and read them aloud for peer group feedback about which one will engage readers most effectively; review the information gathered for a persuasive essay and, after eliminating irrelevant material, assess the remaining details to ensure that they meet the information requirements of the writing task)

Sample questions: “Which of the quotations you have collected are the most relevant to your analysis of this short story?” “Would including a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit perspective on your topic make your argument more complete and persuasive? Why, or why not?”

D2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

D2.1 write for different purposes and audiences using a variety of literary, informational, and graphic text forms (e.g., a report comparing the responses of classmates to a graphic novel studied in class; a narrative poem for peers, based on a short story about cultural identity; a film critique for a First Nation community newspaper; descriptive paragraphs that will form part of a public relations campaign to raise the profile of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit course offerings; the text of a speech for a peer running for student trustee; an opinion piece about the effect of stereotypes, racism, sexism, or culturally inappropriate language on readers)

Sample question: “What text form have you chosen to present the findings of your survey comparing the political priorities of urban and on-reserve First Nations individuals?”

Voice

D2.2 establish a distinctive voice in their writing, modifying language and tone skilfully and effectively to suit the form, audience, and purpose for writing (e.g., use an authoritative tone in a persuasive essay on the necessity of bilateral negotiations between Indigenous governments and various levels of government in Canada; use repeated sentence patterns in the dialogue of a specific character in their script of a skit or short play to establish a distinct personality)

Sample questions: “How can you convey the emotions of a character who has been confronted by a false accusation? What words might this character use?” “How can you project an authoritative tone in this persuasive essay on nation-to-nation negotiations?”

Diction

D2.3 use appropriate descriptive and evocative words, phrases, and expressions imaginatively to make their writing clear, vivid, and interesting for their intended audience (e.g., vary the use of concrete and abstract words appropriately in a poem; use evocative words and phrases accurately and effectively in describing their response to a text, object, or person; use precise words and clear, straightforward sentences to present information and to answer questions in informational texts)

Sample questions: “Where in your essay could you state an idea more clearly or precisely? Where might you add descriptive details?” “Have you used a sufficient variety of concrete words to give your poem energy?”

Sentence Craft and Fluency

D2.4 write complete sentences that communicate their meaning clearly and effectively, skilfully varying sentence type, structure, and length to suit different purposes and making smooth and logical transitions between ideas (*e.g., use coordination and subordination, as appropriate, to emphasize ideas and enhance the readability of sentences; repeat sentences of the same structure to provide rhetorical emphasis*)

Sample questions: “Where in your text might you vary the length of the sentences? What effect would that have on the reader?” “How have you ensured that the transition from one idea to the next is logical?”

Critical Literacy

D2.5 explain, with increasing insight, how their own beliefs, values, and experiences are revealed in their writing, and how these may either reflect or conflict with a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit world view (*e.g., determine whether the ideas in their writing and the language they use to express them are inclusive and non-discriminatory, and explain how they checked for bias; explain how their description of a specific event reveals their values, even if they are not stated explicitly, and make connections between these values and a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit world view*)

Sample questions: “Does your description of this character present her in a positive light or a negative one? How well does that reflect your intention?” “What attitudes and values have you conveyed in this piece of informational writing, even though you have not expressed them explicitly?”

Revision

D2.6 revise drafts to improve the content, organization, clarity, and style of their written work, using a variety of teacher-modelled strategies with increasing effectiveness (*e.g., add precise and appropriate transitional words and phrases to show more clearly the logical relationship between ideas in an argument or position paper; change the order in which types of imagery occur in a poem to heighten the emotional impact*)

Sample questions: “What details in your essay might detract from the overall impression you are trying to achieve?” “How could you reorganize the elements of your poem so that it will appeal more strongly to your readers’ emotions?” “How might you restate the ideas in your opening paragraph to ensure that the core message about First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspectives is clearly and energetically expressed?”

Producing Drafts

D2.7 produce revised drafts of a variety of texts, including increasingly complex texts, written to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations and respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communication styles (*e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Sample questions: “If you were to cut your essay into its separate paragraphs and mix the paragraphs up, would you be able to determine the original order? What does that reveal about the development of your argument?” “What other organizational pattern could you have used in this essay to prove your thesis?”

D3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

Spelling

D3.1 consistently use knowledge of spelling rules and patterns, a variety of resources, and appropriate strategies to identify and correct their own and others’ spelling errors (*e.g., select and use print and electronic spelling resources judiciously, demonstrating awareness of variant spellings, such as U.S. spellings; distinguish between homonyms when editing a peer’s writing; use irregular spellings for effect in an advertisement aimed at a teenaged audience; use electronic dictionaries to check spelling regularly and without prompting; identify words that they regularly misspell and implement appropriate strategies to avoid repeating the errors*)

Sample questions: “What steps can you take to remember the correct spelling of that word and avoid repeating the error in the future?” “Where have you seen irregular spellings used on purpose? Why do you suppose they were used in those cases?”

Vocabulary

D3.2 build vocabulary for writing by confirming word meaning(s) and reviewing and refining word choice, using a variety of resources and strategies, as appropriate for the purpose and with increasing effectiveness (*e.g., consult specialized dictionaries and relevant websites to identify appropriate, current terminology to use in referring to various cultural groups in Canada; incorporate specialized terminology appropriate to the topic in an essay on an issue related to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit cultures or communities; use an etymological dictionary to identify the original meaning of a word and meanings it has acquired over time*)

Sample questions: “How could you explore other ways of wording this idea? What Indigenous and non-Indigenous resources could you consult?” “What other texts could you read to expand the vocabulary you use to write about this topic?” “Are the words you have used in this description likely to be familiar to your audience? If not, what other words might you select?”

Punctuation

D3.3 use punctuation correctly and effectively to communicate their intended meaning (e.g., *use commas correctly to separate words, phrases, and clauses; correctly introduce and punctuate both short and long quotations in the body of an essay, properly setting off block quotations; use semicolons where appropriate to create balance and parallelism in sentences with two or more clauses*)

Sample questions: “How do you know when to run a quotation into the text and when to set it off as a block? What is the accepted way to set off a quotation?”

Grammar

D3.4 use grammar conventions correctly and appropriately to communicate their intended meaning clearly and effectively (e.g., *use a variety of sentence structures correctly to communicate complex ideas; use coordination and subordination correctly and appropriately; use parallelism and balance to aid clarity; use pronoun case, number, and person correctly; use verb tenses correctly in reported dialogue; use active and passive voice appropriately for the purpose and audience*)

Sample questions: “How would you rewrite this series of sentences to create parallelism?” “In general, your consistent use of the active voice to persuade readers of your point of view is appropriate, but where in your essay might you use the passive voice effectively?”

Proofreading

D3.5 regularly proofread and correct their writing (e.g., *ask peers to check their drafts for errors in spelling, vocabulary, punctuation, and grammar, then consult print and electronic resources to confirm the accuracy of the feedback they receive and make corrections where necessary; use the Track Changes function in their word-processing program when entering proofreading changes, and keep a file of these corrections for future reference*)

Sample questions: “What steps can you take to confirm that peer feedback is accurate and appropriate?” “How can the Track Changes tool be of help in the writing process?”

Publishing

D3.6 use a variety of presentation features, including print and script, fonts, graphics, and layout, to improve the clarity and coherence of their written work and to heighten its appeal and effectiveness for their audience (e.g., *select an appropriate format for a letter they are writing to the editor of a specific newspaper; choose design features that will appeal to their peers when creating a blog for that audience*)

Sample questions: “Who is the audience for your blog? How does your choice of design features and layout reflect that audience?”

Producing Finished Works

D3.7 produce pieces of published work to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations and respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communication styles (e.g., *adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Sample questions: “How might incorporating some quotations into your poetry critique help your readers understand your point of view? Where would they be most effective?”

D4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

D4.1 explain which of a variety of strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after writing texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, then evaluate their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers and identify the steps they can take to improve their skills (e.g., *identify different ways of organizing research prior to writing, and explain the most appropriate use for each; share with peers a strategy or technique that they have found helpful in writing effective introductions and conclusions; assess their approach to editing and proofreading their work, and plan to make changes where necessary*)

Sample questions: “How did peer editing improve the quality of a recent piece of your writing? How might you incorporate what you learned into other pieces of written work?” “What have you observed about similarities and differences in your writing process for different text forms?” “Name one aspect of your writing that you have strengthened recently and one aspect that needs more attention. How did you improve in the first area? What will you do to improve in the other area?”

Interconnected Skills

D4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, viewing, and representing, and explain, with increasing insight, how these skills help them write texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., describe some ways in which reading widely has helped them discover new models for their own writing; explain how listening to speeches and oral teachings can help them improve their essay writing and narrative writing*)

Sample question: “How has listening to teachings by Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, and/or knowledge holders helped you improve your ability to write persuasive essays?”

Portfolio

D4.3 select examples of a variety of types of writing that express themes, ideas, and perspectives explored in this course and that they think most clearly reflect their growth and competence as writers, and explain the reasons for their choice (*e.g., select a finished piece of writing for a class anthology of creative writing, and explain why they think it is a good example of their work; select a finished piece of writing that caused them frustration to produce, and explain the problems they encountered and how they attempted to resolve them, and select another finished piece that shows their growth as a writer, and explain how and where it shows improvement*)

Sample questions: “What pieces of your writing represent the style of writing you prefer or the text form you feel most comfortable writing? How can you explain your choice?” “Do you see yourself as a stronger creative writer or technical writer? To what do you attribute this strength?”

E. MEDIA STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Understanding Media Texts:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources;
- E2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques:** identify some media forms and explain how the conventions and techniques associated with them are used to create meaning in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- E3. Creating Media Texts:** create a variety of media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, for different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques;
- E4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as interpreters and creators of media texts, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in understanding and creating media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- E5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Media:** identify various contributions of individuals, organizations, and initiatives, including technological initiatives, to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media production, analysing the social and cultural influence of those contributions and the role of media literacy.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Understanding Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- E1.1** explain how media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, are created to suit particular purposes and audiences (*e.g., describe how a news broadcast by the Aboriginal Peoples Television Network reflects the priorities and interests of its target audience; identify the primary audience for a video game featuring a First Nation character and explain their reasoning; explain the purpose of selecting certain images over others in a documentary about remote Inuit communities*)

Sample questions: “In your opinion, why do some news items about First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals fuel misconceptions while others do not? How might the intended audience of the piece affect the journalist’s accuracy?”
“Whose interests are served by this news item?”

In your opinion, why was this text produced?”
“What is the likely purpose of a museum website showing mainly historical images of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures rather than contemporary images? Who is the primary audience?”

Interpreting Messages

- E1.2** interpret media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, identifying and explaining the overt and implied messages they convey (*e.g., identify some underlying social and/or political messages in a documentary on First Nations, Métis, or Inuit housing, access to clean drinking water, or mental health services, and explain how statistics are used to support those messages; identify the implied message about government legislation and Indigenous peoples in an online broadcast by a major Canadian news network and suggest possible reasons why the message is not openly expressed*)

Sample questions: “What societal values or beliefs do you think are revealed by online news coverage of recent legislation affecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures?” “What is the overt message of this documentary about missing and murdered Indigenous women in Canada? What message or messages are implied? How are the implied messages conveyed? On what facts are they based?”

Evaluating Texts

E1.3 evaluate how effectively information, themes, ideas, issues, and opinions are communicated in media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, and decide whether the texts achieve their intended purpose (e.g., *determine whether a televised press conference about an initiative to improve health services to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities effectively communicated all the information needed by the target audience; assess the relative effectiveness of interviews with filmmakers and actors and interviews with film historians in the documentary Reel Injun*)

Sample questions: “In what ways might a virtual museum exhibition focused on traditional customs and past achievements both help and hinder First Nations, Métis, and Inuit efforts to realize contemporary aspirations?” “In your opinion, what Aboriginal Peoples Television Network programming has changed Canadian attitudes about First Nations, Métis, or Inuit individuals the most? In what ways has it altered these perspectives? Does that reflect the goals of the network? Why, or why not?”

Audience Responses

E1.4 explain why the same media text might prompt a variety of different responses from different audiences (e.g., *provide historical reasons why a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk war veteran and a youth from the same community might have different reactions to the Canadian flag and/or the nation flag representing their home community; identify various possible responses to background information provided by an Indigenous women’s organization in a statement about a government policy position on an issue concerning First Nations, Métis, and Inuit women*)

Sample questions: “Why might some people be offended by a news broadcast suggesting wrongdoing by the Crown in its dealings with Indigenous peoples? Why might a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk activist find such a broadcast refreshing?”

Critical Literacy

E1.5 identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, including increasingly complex or difficult texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *identify First Nations, Métis, or Inuit archetypes and/or stereotypes portrayed in a film, and explain how they are used to confirm or contradict the audience’s expectations about plot or character; assess the realism or lack of realism in the depiction of a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk character in a mainstream television sitcom or drama*)

Sample questions: “Were you expecting this character to be depicted as ‘good’ or ‘bad’? Why? What prior experiences informed your predictions about the character?” “How does the depiction of family structures on mainstream television sitcoms represent or fail to represent First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives on family life and relationships? What issues does that raise about Canadian social values?” “What power imbalance is implied between the characters in this Western? How is this typical of mid-twentieth-century films in this genre?”

Production Perspectives

E1.6 explain how production, marketing, financing, distribution, and legal/regulatory factors influence the First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media industry (e.g., *describe some ways in which the concentration of media ownership affects First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creators; determine whether the Canadian-content regulations of the Canadian Radio-television and Telecommunications Commission [CRTC] contain any provisions for Indigenous content, and explain how that affects First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities; identify some challenges that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creators face in financing projects, and describe some recent attempts to address those challenges*)

Sample questions: “What considerations drove the decision to establish the Aboriginal Peoples Television Network?” “What are some marketing factors that hinder the distribution of media texts intended for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit audiences? How is technology being used to address this challenge?”

E2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

E2.1 identify general and specific characteristics of a variety of media forms and explain, with increasing insight, how they shape content and create meaning in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *digital learning platforms use sound, video, and interactivity to make an Indigenous language accessible and meaningful to learners in communities where there are no speakers of the language; First Nations, Métis, and Inuit websites use links to similar or related content to invite and facilitate further exploration of cultural themes*)

Sample questions: “What characteristics of the Internet make it a good vehicle to promote and support the revitalization of Indigenous languages in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities?” “How has clothing been used in historical and contemporary contexts to convey messages about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural perspectives?”

Conventions and Techniques

E2.2 identify conventions and/or techniques used in a variety of media forms and explain, with increasing insight, how they convey meaning and influence their audience in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *the inclusion of regional news feeds on the Aboriginal Peoples Television Network website fosters awareness of both the diversity and the shared perspectives of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities across Canada; the integration of elements of traditional music into songs by contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit musicians expresses both pride in culture and heritage and resistance to colonialist views*)

Sample questions: “What elements of traditional music did you hear in the *Mother Earth* music recording by Eagle & Hawk? What message do you think those elements were intended to convey, and what was your emotional response?”

E3. Creating Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

E3.1 describe the topic, purpose, and audience for media texts they plan to create on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *a documentary about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists who are using new technologies, with the purpose of encouraging a teenaged*

audience to explore media forms), and identify significant challenges they may face in achieving their purpose (e.g., *gaining permission from artists to incorporate their work into new media texts; learning how to use the technology needed to create their media texts; finding ways to engage their intended audience on a serious topic*)

Sample questions: “Who is the audience for your radio program about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit musicians? What is the purpose of broadcasting these contributions to the music industry? What copyright issues will you need to address before choosing the music examples to include in your program? How might it be helpful to approach some of the musicians you want to showcase?” “What challenges might you face in creating an advertisement to be broadcast during a sporting event? How might you overcome these challenges?”

Form

E3.2 select a media form to suit the topic, purpose, and audience for a media text they plan to create on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and explain why it is the most appropriate choice (e.g., *explain why interviewing a cultural resource person from the local community is an appropriate way to promote an upcoming school event focusing on Métis culture; explain why an editorial cartoon is an effective way to communicate a political viewpoint about an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities*)

Sample questions: “Why might you find a social media advertisement more effective than other forms of communication to promote clothing designs that reflect First Nations, Métis, or Inuit influences?” “Why might a photo-sharing site be a good way to celebrate the diversity of art forms produced in a local Ojibwe community?”

Conventions and Techniques

E3.3 identify a variety of conventions and/or techniques appropriate to a media form they plan to use, and explain how these will help communicate a specific aspect of their intended meaning effectively (e.g., *a ticker tape banner on a website they plan to create will include features such as local news, weather, and sports updates to promote and engage their community; a soundtrack featuring music from the same period as the images in their digital photographic essay will establish the tone and convey the historical context*)

Sample questions: “Which visual and audio techniques will you select in the presentation software to make the transition from one image to the next in your digital photographic essay? How will that help convey your message?”

Producing Media Texts

E3.4 produce media texts, including increasingly complex texts, on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, for a variety of purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques (*e.g., a blog to share views about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works; a video to document the evolution of the Indigenous music industry in Canada*)

E4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

E4.1 explain which of a variety of strategies they found most helpful in interpreting and creating media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, then evaluate their areas of greater and lesser strength as media interpreters and producers and identify the steps they can take to improve their skills (*e.g., identify successful and less successful examples of interpretive and creative tasks they carried out, describe the strategies they used, and explain which strategies worked well and what they would do differently another time*)

Sample questions: “How has your strategy of recording First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content on different media outlets to determine frequency and type of coverage influenced your approach to interpreting media productions? What similar strategy might you use in other contexts?” “How helpful did you find peer feedback when you were making a shortlist of photos to use in your collage? When, or in what way, might the strategy of seeking feedback be counterproductive?”

Interconnected Skills

E4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, and writing, and explain, with increasing insight, how these skills help them interpret and create media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., explain how analysing newspaper articles can help them develop the structure and content of an online petition about the federal government’s response to an Inuit concern; describe the listening skills they drew on to create an effective video interview*)

Sample question: “How did your listening and speaking skills help you develop a short video about Métis families in urban settings?”

E5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Media

By the end of this course, students will:

Media Development

E5.1 describe the contributions of a variety of individuals, organizations, and initiatives to the development and production of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts (*e.g., individuals: Jeff Barnaby, Carla Robinson, Lisa Meeches, Nina Wilson, Sylvia McAdam, Chief Dan George, Alanis Obomsawin; organizations: the National Film Board of Canada, TVOntario, the Aboriginal Peoples Television Network, the Inuit Broadcasting Corporation, Unikkaar Studios Inc., IsumaTV, CBC Indigenous; initiatives: the Idle No More movement; college programs in Indigenous visual and media arts; Indigenous-focused television programs, films, and documentaries; the partnership of SAY Magazine and NationTalk newswire to provide access to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content across media platforms*)

Sample questions: “What recent videos and films have been made by First Nations, Métis, or Inuit directors and producers? What types of support do Indigenous-owned distribution and production companies provide to them? What are some examples of such companies?”

Influence of Media Production

E5.2 analyse the influence of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts on identities and heritage in Canada (*e.g., in terms of offering alternative perspectives on contemporary events in Canada; of incorporating First Nations, Métis, and Inuit voices, world views, and identities into Canadian media productions; of shaping the content and delivery of representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals or communities offered through contemporary mainstream media channels*), commenting with increasing insight on the role of media production as a social and cultural force in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “What are some examples of media texts that have changed Canadian perceptions of the lives of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals? What are some specific changes that have resulted from their production?”

Media Literacy and Media Access

E5.3 analyse the role of media literacy and media access in promoting the work of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media creators, drawing on evidence from a variety of technological initiatives to support their conclusions (*e.g., the use of social media to disseminate media texts reflecting Indigenous perspectives on issues that affect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and individuals; the introduction of accessible and affordable technology and media platforms; the expansion of broadband systems to deliver public service to remote and rural First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities; initiatives to support local decision making about specific community technology needs*)

Sample questions: “Do you think contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts have become more accessible through the use of contemporary social media platforms? Why, or why not? What barriers might remote and rural media creators face in using these social media?” “How does the First Nations Innovation project support First Nations ownership and control of, and access to, information and communication technologies and infrastructure?”

Appendix to the English Courses

CULTURAL TEXT FORMS

Cultural text forms serve an important purpose in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, in that they are used to express and communicate a culture's beliefs and values. Their function and purpose distinguish them from purely artistic creations, though they often have aesthetic qualities as well. They may be elements of material culture, including tangible objects; stories; songs, music, or dances; or cultural practices, including those associated with food or medicines. Some examples of cultural text forms and their significance follow:

- traditional clothing, which often expresses the cultural, spiritual, social, and/or political identities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities
- songs and music, including the practices of drum keepers and dancers (often delineated by gender), used to transmit Indigenous knowledge
- prayers, often expressing belief in the power of spirit to heal
- addresses, affirmations, and orations, illustrating the significance of spoken text
- fire lighting and the burning of sacred medicines to cleanse and purify and/or to communicate with spirit beings
- symbolism embodied in material life to reflect kinship ties, family histories, land agreements, business partnerships, spiritual life, and so on
- oral and written stories used to record and communicate stories of origin, family histories and histories of nations, and relationships to land, spirit, and creation
- languages themselves, which embody and reflect beliefs, values, and significant relationships between humankind and creation

Every culture has a distinct way of creating, passing on, using, and showing respect for its cultural text forms. Some cultural text forms are protected, according to Indigenous traditions. It is therefore critical for educators to understand that it may be necessary for them to engage with and seek direction from the specific Indigenous community from which a cultural text form originates before using it in a classroom setting.

Some cultural text forms, such as prayer, song, and music, are found across First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, while others are unique to particular groups. The chart that follows provides examples of the cultural text forms used by particular cultural groups. It highlights some of the rich forms of communication among Indigenous societies of the oral tradition in Canada.

Cultural Group	Example of Cultural Text Form	Meaning/Purpose	Mode of Communication
Blackfeet	Winter counts	Pictorial calendars or histories drawn on buffalo hides, with a representation of a significant event for each year.	To be viewed, read, and presented
Anishinaabe Ojibwe	Water song	A song sung by women, as the water keepers, to show respect and reverence for the spirit of water, in recognition of its sacredness and its immense importance to all of creation.	To be listened to
Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and other First Nations	Covenant Chain Belt of 1764	A wampum belt displaying symbols made from shells, beads, and string that records the agreement made at Niagara between the British and several First Nations.	To be viewed and read
Haudenosaunee	Thanksgiving address	Words spoken at the beginning of ceremonies and significant meetings to give thanks to the natural environment.	To be listened to
Haudenosaunee	Guswenta or Kaswentha (Two Row Wampum)	A wampum belt displaying symbols made from shells and string that records an agreement between the Haudenosaunee and the Dutch in the mid-seventeenth century. Each row represents a nation, with the belt showing the nations co-existing without interfering in each other's affairs.	To be viewed and read
Métis	Beaded clothing	Items of clothing decorated with detailed beadwork, often in distinctive floral designs. Colours and patterns may convey aspects of Métis history, Métis teachings, and/or family identity.	To be viewed

Cultural Group	Example of Cultural Text Form	Meaning/Purpose	Mode of Communication
Inuit/Inuvialuit	Drum dance	A combination of drumming and dance, traditionally performed by men. Drum dances may be used as a peaceful way to settle disputes.	To be listened to, viewed, and presented
Tsimshian	Button blanket	A robe decorated with white buttons forming images of an animal that represent the clan of the individual wearing the blanket.	To be viewed, read, and presented
Tsimshian	Dances such as the raven dance and the killer whale dance	Dances that communicate important stories about history and creation. Families and/or clans collect and protect these dances, which are passed from one generation to the next.	To be presented and viewed